

08/06/26(E)
[This question paper contains 4 printed pages.]

08.06.2026(E)
Your Roll No.....

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Sr. No. of Question Paper : 2703
Unique Paper Code : 2032201202
Name of the Paper : 18th-century Literature
Name of the Course : Bachelor of Arts – DSC
Semester : II
Duration : 3 Hours



Maximum Marks : 90

Instructions for Candidates

1. Write your Roll No. on the top immediately on receipt of this question paper.
2. This question paper contains 2 parts. **Both** parts are compulsory.
3. Candidates have to answer **ALL** the questions in **Part A** and **ANY THREE** questions in **Part B**.
4. Questions in **Part A** carry 10 marks each and questions in **Part B** carry 20 marks each.

Part A

1. (a) Explain the following lines with reference to context:

For lo! the Board with Cups and Spoons is crown'd,

The Berries crackle, and the Mill turns round:

On shining Altars of *Japan* they raise

The silver Lamp; the fiery Spirits blaze:

From silver Spouts the grateful Liquors glide,

While China's earth receives the smoking Tyde.

P.T.O.

Or

- (b) How does Alexander Pope use the mock-epic conventions to expose the triviality of aristocratic concerns of his age in *The Rape of the Lock*? Discuss with suitable examples.

2. (a) Explain the following lines with reference to context:

The learning of this people is very defective, consisting only in morality, history, poetry, and mathematics, wherein they must be allowed to excel. But the last of these is wholly applied to what may be useful in life, to the improvement of agriculture, and all mechanical arts; so that among us, it would be little esteemed. And as to ideas, entities, abstractions, and transcendentals, I could never drive the least conception into their heads.

Or

- (b) How does Jonathan Swift parody the conventions of travel literature? In what ways does this affect the reader's trust in Gulliver's narrative?

3. (a) Explain the following lines with reference to context:

The only hope of our family now was that the report of Olivia's marriage might be true.

Or

- (b) Analyze Dr. Primrose as a religious and moral figure. To what extent is he an embodiment of Christian virtue, and to what extent is he naive or impractical in dealing with real-world challenges?

PART B

4. (a) Examine the symbolic significance of Belinda's lock. How does the poem negotiate tensions between beauty as power and beauty as vulnerability?

Or

- (b) Is Alexander Pope's satire corrective or merely observational? Evaluate whether the poem ultimately offers a moral stance or remains ambivalent.

5. (a) How does Jonathan Swift use shifts in scale to challenge the idea of human superiority? What do these contrasting worlds reveal about politics and morality in *Gulliver's Travels*?

Or

- (b) Analyse Gulliver's intellectual and emotional transformation from Book III to Book IV. How does his response to Laputa prepare (or fail to prepare) him for his reaction to the Houyhnhnms?

6. (a) The *Vicar of Wakefield* repeatedly stages moments of deception, disguise, and mistaken identity. How do these narrative strategies complicate the reader's understanding of virtue, class, and authority?

Or

- (b) Examine how characters such as Olivia and Sophia are positioned within the novel's moral framework. How does Goldsmith negotiate issues of female virtue, vulnerability, and social judgment?

P.T.O.

7. (a) The 18th century witnesses both the rise of sentimentalism and the persistence of satire. Discuss how these seemingly opposing modes reflect different responses to social change with the help of any two texts in your syllabus.

Or

- (b) How does 18th-century literature negotiate issues of class, hierarchy, and social mobility? Does it reinforce or challenge existing social structures? Elucidate with suitable examples from any two texts in your syllabus.